Pizza Palooza

Work at a Pizza Place

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Design History

This design history documents the evolution of *Pizza-Palooza* from its earliest kitchen-chaos prototype to its current form. Its purpose is to capture not only *what* decisions were made, but *why* they were made—highlighting the reasoning, experiments, revisions, and constraints that shaped the game. By preserving this process, the document helps future developers understand the intent behind each system and ensures the design remains consistent even as new features are added.

Version 1.0 establishes the foundational concepts of *Pizza-Palooza* and outlines the core gameplay loop.

Included in this version:

- Initial high-concept and feature list
- Early kitchen layout and workflow ideas
- First pass on customer system and order flow
- Basic oven timing and ingredient interaction systems

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Game Overview

Philosophical Point #1 – Design Intent

Pizza-Palooza does not attempt to simulate a full restaurant management experience. Instead, it focuses on the *moment-to-moment chaos* of assembling pizzas under pressure. The goal is to create a fast, tactile, arcade-style cooking game where timing, precision, and multitasking matter. The design embraces urgency as a mechanic—players must juggle ovens, ingredients, and customer expectations without ever feeling fully in control.

Philosophical Point #2 – Practical Constraints

The game is built with grounded expectations around scope and technology. It runs on standard PC hardware using a familiar engine to prioritize iteration speed, readability, and performance. The focus is not on photorealistic food simulation, but on clarity, responsiveness, and satisfying interactions.

Philosophical Point #3 – Game Design Goals

Pizza-Palooza aims to be easy to pick up but challenging to master. The design emphasizes:

- **Accessibility** through intuitive controls
- **Replayability** through escalating recipe complexity
- **Challenge** through real-time multitasking and customer pressure

The game respects the player's time while rewarding skill, efficiency, and mastery of the kitchen.

Common Questions

What is the game?

Pizza-Palooza is a fast-paced, first-person pizza-making game where players assemble dough, sauces, toppings, and cooked pizzas to match incoming customer orders. The challenge comes from juggling multiple tasks—prepping ingredients, managing ovens, preventing burns, and keeping customers satisfied.

Why create this game?

The game was created to explore whether *tactile, action-driven cooking* could stand on its own without heavy management systems or long-term progression. Many cooking games simplify the process or rely on menu-based interactions. *Pizza-Palooza* asks: *What if making the pizza itself was the entire challenge?*

Where does the game take place?

The game takes place inside a bustling, slightly chaotic pizzeria kitchen. Counters, ovens, prep stations, and ingredient shelves fill the compact space, creating natural obstacles and workflow challenges.

What do I control?

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The player controls the hands and movement of the pizzeria's newest cook. They grab ingredients, assemble pizzas, operate ovens, and deliver finished orders.

How many characters do I control?

Only one—the player character. All depth comes from the player's skill and mastery of the kitchen.

What is the main focus?

The main focus is **timely, accurate pizza creation** under pressure. Players must balance speed, precision, and multitasking to keep customers happy.

What's different?

Unlike other cooking games, *Pizza-Palooza* emphasizes:

- Real-time oven management
- Tactile, physics-based dough and topping interactions
- Dynamic customer personalities and reactions
- A compact kitchen that forces efficient movement

Feature Set

Core Gameplay

- First-person, action-driven pizza assembly
- Real-time multitasking across multiple stations
- Increasingly complex orders and recipes
- Fast, arcade-style pacing

Customers & Challenge

- Dynamic patience system
- Customers react to speed, accuracy, and mistakes
- Lost customers reduce score and tips
- Rush hours create intense difficulty spikes

Kitchen & Systems

- Dough station, sauce station, topping counter, ovens, and delivery counter
- Burnable pizzas and oven timers
- Ingredient restocking
- Limited counter space

Visuals & Presentation

- Clean, readable kitchen layout

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- Clear visual feedback for cooking states (raw → cooking → perfect → burnt)
- Expressive customer reactions

User Interface (UI/UX)

- Order tickets with clear ingredient lists
- Timer indicators for ovens and customer patience
- Minimal clutter for fast readability

Progression & Replayability

- Expanding recipe complexity
- Challenge mode with escalating rush hours
- Co-op mode for two-player kitchen chaos
-

The Game World

The Physical World

Overview

The game takes place entirely inside a lively pizzeria kitchen. The environment is intentionally compact to create natural pressure—players must navigate tight spaces, avoid obstacles, and manage stations efficiently.

Key Locations

- **Prep Counter** – Dough shaping, sauce spreading, topping assembly
- **Oven Wall** – Multiple ovens with independent timers
- **Ingredient Shelf** – Restocking and grabbing ingredients
- **Delivery Counter** – Where finished pizzas are served
- **Back-of-House Staff Area** – NPCs add humor and atmosphere

Travel

The player moves freely in first-person, navigating the kitchen to complete tasks.

Scale

The kitchen is designed around tight, efficient movement. Every station is reachable within seconds, but poor routing wastes precious time.

Objects

Players interact with:

- Dough

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- Sauce ladles
- Topping bins
- Oven doors
- Pizza peels
- Order tickets
- Timers

Time System

Time is measured through customer orders. Each order has:

- A patience timer
- A cooking timer
- A delivery window

Rendering System

Overview

The game uses the Unity URP pipeline to render all assets with clean lighting and smooth performance.

3D Rendering

All kitchen objects, ingredients, and characters are rendered in stylized 3D for clarity and charm.

Camera

First-person camera with slight head bob and interaction reticles.

Static Camera Positioning

The camera remains player-controlled but does not leave the kitchen.

Game Engine

Overview

The game uses Unity Engine version 6000.3.8f1, supporting Windows 10/11.

Object Tracking

The engine tracks:

- Active orders
- Pizza states (raw, cooking, cooked, burnt)
- Customer patience
- Ingredient quantities

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Collision Detection

Used for:

- Dough shaping
- Topping placement
- Oven interactions
- Counter space limitations

Lighting Models

A warm, inviting kitchen light with accent lights on stations.

World Layout

Overview

The kitchen is divided into functional zones:

- **Prep Station** – Dough, sauce, toppings
- **Oven Station** – Multiple ovens with timers
- **Delivery Counter** – Final order handoff
- **Storage** – Ingredient restocking

Game Characters

Overview

The game features:

- The player (unnamed cook)
- Background staff (non-interactive)
- Customers with varied personalities

Obtaining Characters

Characters are not collected; the focus is on player skill.

Customer Types

- **Impatient Teen** – Low patience, low tip
- **Foodie Blogger** – High standards, high tip potential
- **Busy Parent** – Moderate patience, simple orders
- **Tourist Group** – Large combo orders

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User Interface

Overview

UI is clean, readable, and focused on order clarity.

Order Tickets

Show:

- Pizza type
- Ingredients
- Special instructions
- Customer patience bar

Timers

- Oven timers
- Customer patience timers

Pause Menu

Includes:

- Settings
- Controls
- Restart shift

Musical Scores & Sound Effects

Overview

Audio enhances the frantic kitchen atmosphere.

Dynamic Sound Volume

Separate sliders for:

- Master
- Music
- SFX

Sound Design

Includes:

- Oven dings
- Dough slaps

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- Topping plops
- Customer reactions
- Order ticket printer

Single-Player Game

Overview

Players complete as many orders as possible within a timed shift.

Story

Light narrative: you are the newest cook in a chaotic but lovable pizzeria.

Hours of Gameplay

Endless replayability through challenge modes and co-op.

Victory Conditions

No traditional win—players aim for high scores and ratings.

Training System

Overview

The Training System introduces players to the basics of pizza-making and kitchen navigation in a low-pressure environment. It ensures new players understand core mechanics before entering full shifts.

Training Steps

- **Movement & Interaction:** Learn to move, grab items, and use stations.
- **Dough & Sauce Basics:** Practice shaping dough and applying sauce correctly.
- **Toppings & Assembly:** Follow simple order tickets and place toppings accurately.
- **Oven Management:** Learn timing, avoid burns, and manage multiple ovens.
- **Practice Orders:** Complete a small set of simulated orders to prepare for real gameplay.

Purpose

Training builds confidence, teaches efficient workflow, and prepares players for the fast pace of actual shifts.

Education & Skill Development

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Overview

The Education System helps players improve over time through optional learning tools, advanced techniques, and performance feedback.

Skill Areas

- **Efficiency:** Faster movement, better station routing, smarter prep.
- **Timing & Multitasking:** Managing ovens, prioritizing orders, juggling tasks.
- **Recipe Mastery:** Learning specialty pizzas and complex combos.
- **Customer Insight:** Understanding patience levels and personality types.

Tools for Learning

- **Kitchen Tips:** Optional hints that appear during gameplay.
- **Practice Mode:** A no-pressure space to experiment with recipes and timing.
- **Shift Feedback:** Post-shift summaries highlighting accuracy, timing, and improvement areas.